Letter of Recommendation

2026-10-21

To Whom it May Concern,

I am an visiting assistant professor of philosophy at Stetson University. I defended my dissertation at Saint Louis University in 2024 on moral epistemology. My interests are generally in the areas of mind, epistemology, and aesthetics. I have known Jacob since the first class I taught at Stetson University. He was in my aesthetics class. Since arriving here as a visiting professor, I have taught aesthetics, logic, philosophy of mind, and philosophy of law course. I have had Jacob in each of my upper division courses.

The needs of the student body here at Stetson are unique. Most often, due to pressing financial responsibilities, our students are motivated by financial constraints. They generally view graduation and decisions about courses of study through a lens of though not immediate, economic security. For this reason, our pre-law offerings are often very attractive to our student recruits. Although here at Stetson, it can be difficult to motivate the kinds of aesthetic concerns that have been raised in discussions of beauty more generally, Jacob has always given the same care and attention to these issues as he has to others that more align with his own aims and pursuits. He is always very careful and clear in his ability to focus on and immerse himself in the kinds of debates held by authors who generally had the freedom to engage in such debates. He was always able to appreciate the form an argument took rather than being distracted by the subject matter of the argument.

There are a handful of students that I have had in my classes that were able to ignore their more immediate concerns and focus on reasoning well and Jacob was at the top of this group. In my philosophy of mind course that I am currently teaching, he often asks questions that help to illuminate the issue for the rest of the class. Jacob has always been a great communicator, he asks tough questions in class but does so in a way that helps other students open up. He is a very conscientious contributor, both during discussions and in his submitted work.

He asks questions in such a way that the other students can identify their own struggles with the materials and that gives them a way to understand their own impediments to accepting claims made by the authors we are reading. In each instance he shows himself to be a careful thinker. His assignments are always completed on time and show a high level of attention to detail, not only in his command of grammar, but also in his understanding of the content.

When mistakes are pointed out to him, he follows up with questions, asking for clarity and understanding. He is in our department often as he has a close relationship with his advisor Josh Rust. It is in my opinion, that these personality traits would make him very successful in whatever he chooses to do and an excellent contribution to your institution.